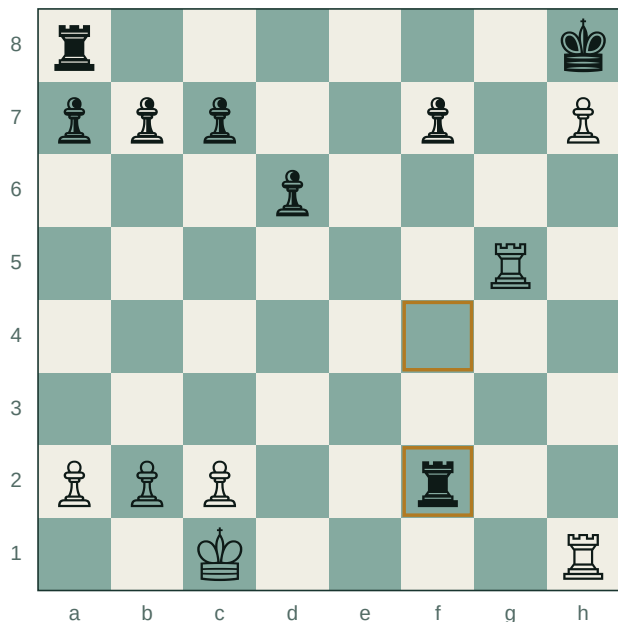


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 26

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 25...Rf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Rhg1 a5 27. Rg8+ Kxh7 28. Rxa8

26.Rhg1 The rook moves from h1 to g1. Recorded reply: **26...a5**.

27.Rg8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g8 it attacks king on h8 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **27...Kxh7**.

28.Rxa8 The rook captures the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.